Sprint & release checklists

v1.4.0-docs.1
target template v1.4.0

> Printable close gates for sprints and releases. Full lifecycle: HOW TO USE §11–12.

SPRINT KICKOFF

- ☐ All tasks pass DoR; dependencies linked.
- ☐ Sprint tracker Status **In Progress**; goal/tasks/risks announced.
- ☐ Parent release tracker verified; scope fits the sprint window.

SPRINT DURING

- ☐ Track child issues via the board; update the sprint only for blockers, deferrals, scope changes.
- ☐ WIP = 1 per owner; plan changes dated + labelled.

SPRINT CLOSE

- ☐ All children Done or explicitly deferred with a `plan-change` link.
- ☐ Post sprint demo/exit comment: goal, outcome, evidence, carried-over, risks.
- ☐ Close the sprint issue; update parent release tracker.
- ☐ Acceptance: no Done sprint with open children unless deferral is recorded.

RELEASE KICKOFF

- ☐ Release tracker **In Progress**; scope/sprints/gates/rollback/artifacts confirmed.
- ☐ Required checks and tokens ready; dry-run defaults documented.
- ☐ Every gate has an owner and evidence expectation.

RELEASE DURING

- ☐ Update the release tracker at each sprint close: completed scope, risks, decisions, estimate changes.
- ☐ Do not duplicate sprint status; resolve blockers at the release level.

RELEASE CLOSE

- ☐ Every gate checked with linked evidence.
- ☐ Tag matches versions; build/publish artifacts + checksums (`SHA256SUMS`).
- ☐ Release notes + docs updated; milestone/release tracker closed.
- ☐ Final summary posted; known issues + rollback documented.
- ☐ No close with open child sprints unless explicitly deferred.

CLOSE BLOCKERS — FIX BEFORE EXIT

- Unchecked acceptance criteria or missing evidence: not Done.
- Open child issues without a `plan-change` deferral: sprint/release not closeable.
- Unresolved known risk or no rollback plan: release not closeable.
- Parent tracker not updated: the close is incomplete.

EVIDENCE TO ATTACH

Commands + results, artifact checksums, workflow run links, audit summary, and any deviation. Rollback: revert the release PR or restore the previous exact tag/commit and reset `automation.templateVersion`.

Links: sprint-close · release-close · REFERENCE §16 · UPGRADING